Department of Communication Studies and Studio Arts
University of Houston- Clear Lake
COMM 1315: Public Speaking
Spring 2022 - 3 Credit Hours
Location: 8:30 & 10am Bayou 1104; 11:30-Bayou 1228
ONLINE FOR WEEKS 1 AND TWO FOR COVID: ASYNCHRONOUS AND ONLINE, SO WHEREEVER YOU ARE ☺

Section: 1315.03, 04, 05
Instructor: Dr. Andrea Baldwin.
Office: BAYOU 2121.3
Virtual Office Hours: **Mondays-** 10am-noon
Tuesdays- 1pm-2pm;
Wednesdays- 10am- noon (DIGITAL)and **by appt. via ZOOM**
Email: Baldwin@uhcl.edu or Blackboard
Phone: 281-283-3479
Instruction Mode: Online (COVID-19)

Required Texts:

Fassett, Deanna L. & Nainby, Kieth. (2021) *Empowering Public Speaking.* Congella.

Additional Materials to assist your learning experience in this course include:

- Access to Blackboard Learn found at: https://blackboard.uhcl.edu/webapps/login
- Access to 3X5 notecards
- Access to the internet to view supplemental instructional videos and examples.
- Your experiences and opinions.

General Course Objectives:

In a complex and culturally diverse world, the ability to communicate effectively has become increasingly important. This course has two interrelated goals. First, it will introduce you to the basic concepts, vocabulary, theories, and processes relevant to understanding oral communication in a variety of public and cultural contexts. Second, it will enhance your communication skills by providing systematic opportunities to practice clear, critical, and ethical oral communication. Since it is our intent to integrate theory and practice throughout the course, your classroom experience will combine lectures, discussions, small group activities, written assignments, public speeches, and out of class observations. Together we will foster and maintain an interactive, open, and supportive classroom environment that promotes insight into self and others, critical thinking, intellectual growth, and communicative competence. The core objectives meet the Texas Core Curriculum objectives for the Communication Foundational component Area.

Course Goals:

--To understand and interpret public communication processes
--To develop invitational, organizational, and expressive skills
--To develop understanding and acceptance of communication ethics
--To apply elements of audience analysis
--To research, develop, and deliver extemporaneous speeches with effective verbal and nonverbal techniques.
--To articulate the functions of power, identity, and Positionality as constitutive of communication
--To develop critical skills appropriate for responsible receivership of messages
--To gain understanding of relationships between self, message, and others in public communication interactions
--To embody/enact communication behaviors that reflect each of the goals listed above

Course Requirements:

1. **TWO EXAMS** (objective and short answer/essay format as well as oral) designed to demonstrate basic understanding and application of selected concepts and terminology introduced in the text and lecture/discussions.
2. **THREE PUBLIC SPEECHES** designed to increase your skill in creating, organizing, delivering, and interpreting informative and persuasive messages.
3. **ONE COMMUNICATION ANALYSIS PAPER** (3-5pgs) designed to extend and apply course principles to a public speaking and/or intercultural communication situation the student has experienced.
4. Additional short written assignments or in-class activities to be assigned by the instructor.
5. ***Attendance and participation is an important part of your responsibility as a member of this class.***

Grading Policies

Assignment:	Points	Percentages	Points=course grade
2 exams	100 each	20%	200pts
3 speeches	100,150,250	50%	500pts
1 Analysis Paper	150	15%	150pts
Additional Assignments	150	15%	150pts
Total		100%	1000pts

Please be aware…
All assignments will receive a raw numerical score. Please track your grades on your own throughout the course. At any time you can determine your approximate letter grade by calculating the percentage of points you have earned out of the points possible for each graded assignment.

Course Policies

Attendance:

As members of a learning community, ***your presence is appreciated, and your absence is noticed***. The contributions you make to class help us to both sustain our community and to engage the material in ways we likely would not if you were not here. As such, ***the class values you being with us, in class***. Additionally, when we enter into the learning community by registering for the course, we agree to a tacit social contract. That contract ensures that all participants—you and I—will attend every class meeting, engage one another in an informed and spirited manner, and complete all assigned responsibilities on time. I will begin taking attendance in the second week of classes. ***You are allowed (2) absence in the course of the semester without penalty.*** (Speech days do not count as a "free" absence.) Each unaccounted for absence after two, I will take ***15 points off your final score. It is your responsibility to make sure you are accounted for on attendance by the end of the class period each time.***

Late Arrival to Class:

The class values you being with us, in class! This also means that we value your presence throughout the entire class period. Please make sure your schedule allows you to be prepared to engage the class day at the scheduled time. I will consider you to be absent if you miss more than ½ of the class period. If you do arrive late, please enter with as little distraction as possible. If we are working in groups, find a group on your own and ask your group mates to explain the task. If someone is giving a speech, wait for the applause before you walk in. ***Please remember it is your responsibility to make sure you are accounted for on the attendance by the end of class period each time.***

Attendance and participation in the time of COVID-19: As the above protocols are in place, please be mindful of your health and the health of others around you:

- ***If you are feeling sick, I encourage you to not come to class.***
- ***If you have been exposed to COVID-19, I ENCOURAGE YOU TO NOT COME TO CLASS.***
- ***If you find you must miss for illness or you are feeling symptoms, please email me to let me know so we can make accommodations.***

As you attend class in the time of COVID-19: As the above protocols are in place, please be mindful of your health and the health of others around you:

- ***Please be respectful of others preventative measures.***
- ***Wearing a mask or other PPP in class is encouraged.***

Excused Absences:
The University recognizes certain events and obligations as "excused absences." You must notify me prior to such absences with documentation from the sponsoring program or department, including contact information. You are responsible for making up all work missed due to absences in a timely manner, *and so please contact me at least 2 calendar days before your absence.* The documented excused absences, should they equal or exceed your "free" absences, will replace those "free" absences in the attendance policy above; any absences beyond the excused absences will reduce your final grade as outlined above. Medical emergencies and other personal obligations *are not automatically excused absences*. Documentation, explanations, and prior warning for such absences are strongly encouraged, but it is left to my discretion as to how they will be dealt with in the attendance policy. University policy mandates attendance during the final exam period.

Late Work:
I will provide you with copies of all homework assignments and handouts (or someone you designate) to pick up after any class you miss. Some of these may also be available on our blackboard course page. It is your responsibility to get and complete these assignments by the due date in order to receive full credit for the assignment. In general, no makeup speeches, exams, or written assignments will be allowed. In the event of a personal emergency and at my discretion, makeup work may be accepted for half credit.

Readings:
Weekly readings include the textbook and supplemental materials on Blackboard, all readings must be completed before turning in assignments. Lectures and online materials are intended to compliment, not duplicate, that information. Students are responsible for all assigned readings.

Student/Instructor Correspondence: Students are expected to exercise effective electronic communication. Include the course name, number, and a brief descriptive subject heading (i.e. "COMM 1315- Section 4- Presentation grade"). Messages should include and appropriate greeting, such as "Dear Professor Baldwin." Provide context, so that the instructor can best assist you. Students are encouraged to use "Blackboard Messages," to ensure that messages stay within our Blackboard course. Please allow up to two business days for a response.

Office Hours and Appointments: Students are encouraged to keep an open dialogue with the instructor throughout the semester. This includes answering questions about assignments, course expectations, due dates, etc. To make an appointment, send the instructor and e-mail. Meetings are held face-to-face at the instructor office.

Discussion of Graded Assignments: Students are encouraged to take active interest in their evaluation. When discussing grades with the instructor, be prepared to make a well-developed case regarding the *criteria for the assignment.* Grade appeals must occur in writing no later than one week after reviewing the

evaluation. This ensured that all disputes are handled in the same way. **Please wait 24 hours before grade discussion.**

Writing:
Even though this class focuses on oral and embodied communication, many assignments require you to report analyses of such communication in a written format. For this reason, the quality of your writing matters and is part of the content of this course. **"Writing" here includes the format and content of your emails. I would expect that your emails are written professionally.** While I do not expect all of you to be perfect writers, your writing is part of what I evaluate. This evaluation includes assessments of organization, sentence structure, accurate word choice, typographical mistakes, spelling, and basic grammar errors in your writing. If you feel or if we discover that you have trouble writing up to the standards required for this course, please consider turning in rough drafts of your work well before assignment deadlines and/or consulting with a tutor at the UHCL Writing Center.

Writing Center:

The UHCL Writing Center staff works both face-to-face and online with writers regardless of skill level and at any stage of the writing process of any writing project, including essays, emails, resumes, and more. Through one-on-one consultations, peer writing consultants work collaboratively with writers to build their writing skills. The Writing Center also offers the following services and resources, which can be found in further detail at https://www.uhcl.edu/writing-center/:

- **Workshops:** Informal group settings to talk about specific academic and creative writing topics like APA formatting or science fiction worldbuilding
- **Drop-off Consultations:** Submit up to 5 pages of your paper and receive an email with a link to a short video offering feedback
- **Writing Circles:** Support groups for creative and academic writers to set and achieve wordcount goals in weekly meetings
- **Studio Projects**: Recurring appointments for writers with large projects
- **Tip Sheets and Writing Guides**: Handcrafted by peer writing consultants

You can book an appointment at https://uhcl.mywconline.com/ or stop by the Writing Center's Online Writing Studio in Microsoft Teams at https://tinyurl.com/onlinewritingstudio for a drop-in consultation any time **Mon-Thurs 9:00 a.m. – 7:00 p.m, Fri 10:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m.,** or **Sat 10:00 a.m. – 3:00 p.m.** For more information, contact the Writing Center at writingcenter@uhcl.edu or by phone at **281-283-2910.**

University of Houston- Clear Lake Policy Statements

Accessibility:
The Department of Communication Studies strives to be conscious of and sensitive to disability issues. In the spirit of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), I wish to make this course as accessible as possible to students with disabilities, temporary medical conditions, or mental or emotional health issues that may affect any aspect of course assignments or participation. I invite you to communicate with me at the beginning of the semester or at your discretion about any accommodations that will improve your experience of or access to the course. We can create an agreement to document accommodations.

The University of Houston System complies with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 and the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, pertaining to the provision of reasonable academic adjustments/auxiliary aids for students with a disability. In accordance with Section 504 and ADA guidelines, each University within the System strives to provide reasonable academic adjustments/auxiliary aids to students who request and require them. **If you believe that you have a disability requiring academic adjustments/auxiliary aid, please**

contact Disability Services at (281) 283-2648 or disability@uhcl.edu or visit them in the Student Services Building, Rom 1.301. To ensure your accommodations are in place for the entire semesters, please request your accommodation letters from Disability Services and provide them to your instructor at the beginning of the semester.

Academic Honesty:
We welcome you to this classroom community with the assumption that the work you do will be your own. However, distinguishing your work from the work of another can be tricky at times, for both you and your instructor. You should know that presenting another's work as your own, even if by accident, is a serious violation of the *Student Conduct Code*. Whether quoting or paraphrasing (or even summarizing) someone else's work, you should cite your sources; failure to do so constitutes an act of plagiarism. This policy applies to papers and speeches. Buying a paper online, copying text from several web sites, and turning in someone else's paper (even with a few words changed) are all examples of plagiarism when you claim such work as your own. (Note: As services selling such papers have increased in number, so have services that track plagiarism using sources from the internet.) Suspected cases of plagiarism will be investigated following Article V of the *Student Conduct Code*; if plagiarism is substantiated, the perpetrator may face failing the assignment, failing the course, disciplinary censure, and/or suspension from the university, depending on the details of the case. A good rule to follow: when in doubt, cite where the information is coming from. If you are uncertain whether you are citing sources sufficiently and appropriately enough to avoid plagiarism, please consult your instructor or a tutor at the Writing Center.

Important Dates:

- Last day to withdraw/drop 04/13/22
- Last day to apply for Graduation 03/20/22

Incomplete:
A grade of Incomplete ('I') may be given at the discretion of the instructor to students who are making satisfactory progress in a course. Incompletes are given for emergency situation that occurs after the withdrawal date but prior to the end of the semester, at which prevent the student from completing course requirements. When assigning the grade of 'I,; instructors provide students with an Incomplete Grade Contract that outlines the work to be accomplished before the 'I' can be converted to a final grade and specifies a deadline date.

6 Drop Rule Limitation for Undergraduate Courses: Students who entered college for the first time in Fall 2007 or later should be aware of the course drop limitation imposed by the Texas Legislature. Dropping this or any other course between the first day of class and the census date for the semester/session does not affect your 6 drop rule count. Dropping a course between the census date and the last day to drop a class for the semester/session will count as one of your 6 permitted drops. You should take this into consideration before dropping this or any other course. Visit www.uhcl.edu/records for more information on the 6 drop rule and the census date information for the semester/session.

Faculty Course Evaluations
At the end of the semester, students will be asked to complete a course evaluation used by the University to monitor the quality of the instruction. You should take this evaluation seriously and answer each item to the best of your ability since the cumulative results are important to the university and your instructor. The confidentiality of your responses is protected: you submit your evaluation anonymously and I will receive the summary of the evaluations only after your final grades for the course have been submitted.

Emergencies and Natural Disasters: In the event of a school closure due to weather and/or natural disasters, your instructor will post instructions on Blackboard. In the event of a power failure, please adhere to UHCL's telephone and web instructions and wait for further communication from your instructor.

Sexual Misconduct Reporting and Awareness: "The policy of UHCL is to ensure equal opportunity in all its educational programs and activities, and all terms and conditions of employment without regard to age, race, color, disability, religion, national origin, veteran's status, genetic information or sex (including pregnancy), except where such a distinction is required by law. Additionally, UHCL prohibits discrimination in all aspects of employment and educational programs on the basis of sexual orientation, gender identity or gender expression. Employees, students and visitors to campus with questions and/or complaints regarding discrimination or sexual misconduct (such as sexual violence) under Title IX may contact the Title IX Coordinator: Title IX/Equity and Diversity Office, Bayou B2323, 281-283-2305, titleix@uhcl.edu. For more information, see www.uhcl.edu/titleix."

Changes to the course syllabus: The instructor reserves the right to make appropriate changes in the syllabus. It is the student's responsibility to keep updated on course information if they are absent.

Spring 2022 Schedule (Tu & Th)

Complete reading prior to arriving at class on the assigned due date.

****As of January 7, 2022, UHCL announced we would be soft opening campus (Online). For week's 1 & 2 we will be ONLINE ASYNCHRONOUS.**

What this means for this class is that Weekly or bi weekly, always at 830am, for weeks 1 & 2 (and possibly longer pending the Pandemic). The videos will always be up for the rest of the semester, unless specified, however for each video, you will have a small assignment that proves you attended class. You will have the whole day or even longer to watch the videos and complete the assignments. However, it is your responsibility to do so.

Week 1 and two Online Asynchronous

WK	Date	Discussion	Assignments Due
1	**1/18**	Course Introduction	
1	**1/20**	Public Speaking is Constitutive	*Empowering* Ch. 1
2	**1/25**	Public Speaking is Relational	*Empowering* Ch. 2
2	**1/27**	**Assign Speech #1**	**See Blackboard for Daily Assingment**

Week 3 and On: Face to Face in class

WK	Date	Discussion	Assignments Due
3	2/1	Public Speaking is Responsive	*Empowering Ch. 3*
3	2/3	Public Speaking is Specific to Time, Place and Purpose	*Empowering Ch. 4*
4	2/8	Workshopping Speech #1 Prep	
4	2/10	**Speech #1**	
5	2/15	**Speech #1**	
5	2/17	**Speech #1**	
6	2/22	Public Speaking is Pedagogical	*Empowering Ch 5*
6	2/24	Public Speaking is Structured **Assign MIDTERM**	*Empowering Ch. 6*
7	3/1	Public Speaking is Informed **Assign Speech #2**	*Empowering Ch. 7*
7	3/3	Public Speaking is Performance	*Empowering Ch. 8*
8	3/8	Public Speaking is Impassioned	*Empowering Ch. 9*
8	3/10	**Midterm**	
9	3/15 & 3/17	***Spring Break! No Class! Have Fun and be safe ☺***	
10	3/22	**Speech #2**	
10	3/24	**Speech #2**	
11	3/29	**Speech #2**	
11	3/30	Public Speaking is Accountable	*Empowering Ch. 10*

		Assign CAP PAPER	
12	4/5	Public Speaking is Evolving **Assign Speech #3**	*Empowering Ch. 11*
12	4/7	Public Speaking is Empowering **Assign Final**	*Empowering Ch. 12*
13	4/12	Speech Prep Day	
13	4/14	No Class- *White rose of Tejas*	
14	4/19	Final	***CAP PAPER DUE***
14	4/21	Final	
15	4/26	**Final**	
15	4/28	**Speech #3**	
Final	May 3 & 5	**Speech #3**	**Times:** **830: Tues: 7am-10am** **10am: Thurs: 10am-1pm** **1130: Tues: 10a,-1pm**

I confirm that I have read this syllabus and understand the expectations and course policies it details:

_____ _____

Signature Date

_____

Name (printed)